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In the world of technology, buzzwords come and go every single year. One could say that buzzword of today is Artificial intelligence, but here we are looking at one that is all set to take over that role very soon if it hasn't already - blockchain.

While many discussions and a large portion of the interest around blockchain revolves around its implications for the financial sector through cryptocurrencies and more, another sector that could be greatly benefited from blockchain technology is supply chain management (SCM). However, why would the supply chain management sector need an intervention?

WHERE'S THE CHAIN

There was a time when supply chains were quite simple since most of the actual supply was done locally. Today, a standard supply chain spans the globe, involves hundreds of stakeholders, a multitude of invoices and documents and possibly endless ways for the entire thing to go wrong. While the rest of the world is moving ahead towards



Customers today want complete transparency regarding what they are purchasing

interconnectedness, current SCM systems have fallen behind. A particular shipping container originating in East Africa and going to Europe, according to shipping giant Maersk, needs to pass through 30 people and organisation with a cumulative number of interactions that crosses 200.

Within a given supply chain today, there are multiple data silos. These are points where the data is isolated

and is not connected to other points on the chain. As a result, there's little importance on maintaining the integrity of what's flowing through the supply chain, resulting in contamination, counterfeiting, and poor efficiency. Needless to say, this not only hurts the companies but their customers too, along with the environment through wastage, as well as other companies who are invested in making the supply chain sustainable. Additionally, today's customers are highly technol-

ogy friendly and environmentally conscious. Most customers want to know where the product they're purchasing comes from, how it was made, and what is its current status with as much precision as possible. This pressure on supply chain stakeholders is also something that blockchain implementations can solve.

HOW WILL BLOCKCHAIN HELP

As a concept, it is easy to see how blockchain would help the ailing

